

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with over two years of practical legal experience in litigation support and commercial contracts, gained at BCLP, Citizens Advice, Adobe and Q-Legal. Experienced in reviewing and compiling hearing bundles, drafting correspondence and procedural documents, maintaining organised case files, meeting submission deadlines and working directly with clients on active matters. Strong written English and communication skills; familiar with iManage and electronic court filing portals.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize: top 20 of a 200-student cohort, with partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Prepared and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial in a complex investment arbitration; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Amended sections of the Claimant's memorial and conducted legal research to support the team's drafting
- Became the only junior on the matter shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated outstanding documents and tracked actions across the file to ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Compiled electronic hearing bundles and reviewed documents in preparation for court hearings; assisted with skeleton arguments and other court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Assisted with court filings using electronic filing portals; handled matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages a caseload across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters: takes detailed client statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, and maintains confidential case records throughout each matter
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals
- Meets submission deadlines while managing competing priorities across an active caseload

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, identified compliance risks in the client's data processing and drafted clear, commercially focused written advice
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer obligations
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate proposed amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise drafting and report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; electronic court filing portals; legal research databases; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle compilation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters